

Finger Lakes — Thu afternoon & Friday

Tonight: Marathon · **Friday night:** Buffalo by Maghrib (~6:57 PM) · **Food:** halal-friendly

NYS Park day pass

About \$8–\$10 per car per day. Keep the receipt — valid at other NY State Parks the same day.

Footwear

Wet stone steps and gorge mist. Wear trail shoes with real grip (not flat sneakers).

Buffalo Maghrib Friday

About 6:57 PM. Leave Ithaca by 3:30 PM. Asr (~4:20) is a rest-area stop on I-90.

Thursday after lunch — Watkins Glen & SheQuaga

Today

Goal: The video’s first “must” afternoon: Watkins Glen Gorge Trail, then the 8-minute SheQuaga stop. Sleep in Marathon. Times assume you roll out around 1 PM.

Time	Activity	Duration	Drive	Notes from the video
~1:00 PM	Leave Marathon	—	~60–75 min	Trail shoes, water, prayer mat. ~52 mi via I-86 / NY-14.
~2:10 PM	Watkins Glen Gorge Trail	~1 hr 45	—	~2.2 mi, ~19 falls, tunnels, cliffs, muddy stairs. North entrance is quieter; Main/South has restrooms. If the gorge is a wall of people, use Indian Trail or North Rim.
~4:00 PM	Drive to SheQuaga Falls	~8–10 min	~3.5 mi	Straight into Montour Falls.
~4:15 PM	SheQuaga / Chequaga Falls	~15 min	—	~165 ft. Park S Genesee Street — the falls GPS pin puts you on the bridge with no parking.
~4:30 PM	Drive back to Marathon	~55–70 min	~50 mi	Do not add Taughannock tonight. The gorge would finish after dark.
~5:40 PM	Marathon for the night	—	—	Dinner, prayer, early sleep. Friday starts at 7:15.

If the gorge is slammed

- North entrance is the quieter end.
- Indian Trail or North Rim covers the park without the stair queue.
- Still keep SheQuaga — it's a 10-minute stop.

Left out today

- Taughannock moves to Friday morning (daylight for the base walk).
- Buttermilk, Cornell, and Ithaca Falls are Friday.

Friday — Taughannock, Ithaca, then Buffalo

Maghrib deadline

Goal: Video's quieter big waterfall, then the Ithaca hits that fit before a 3:30 PM departure. Buffalo Maghrib is about **6:57 PM**.

Time	Activity	Duration	Drive	Notes
7:15 AM	Leave Marathon, car packed	—	~55–70 min	You're not coming back tonight.
~8:30 AM	Taughannock overlook	~15 min	—	215 ft, taller than Niagara. Top view first.
~8:45 AM	Gorge Trail to the base	~45–75 min	~5 min	Lower lot on NY-89. Flat gravel. Quieter than Watkins Glen. Reuse the park pass.
~10:00 AM	Cayuga shore prayer / rest	~20 min	—	Lawn between overlook and lower lot. Then drive to Ithaca.
~10:45 AM	Ithaca Falls	~20 min	~25 min	Lake St. Deck or a 5-minute walk to the base.
11:15 AM	Halal lunch	~1 hr	~5 min	Adam Grill (114 W Green) or Casablanca (111 E State). Confirm open. Skip the video's tacos unless you check halal.
12:30 PM	Buttermilk Falls	~75 min	~10 min	Lower entrance. Gorge Trail up the stairs, Rim Trail down. Turn around if you're still climbing at 1:30.
~1:50 PM	Cornell view, only if on time	~40 min	~10 min	Cascadilla Gorge up toward campus, or just Libe Slope. Skip a booked tour.
3:30 PM	Leave for Buffalo	~2 hr 15–2 hr 45	I-90 W	Hard stop. Asr ~4:20 at a rest area. Aim to park in Buffalo by ~6:15, before Maghrib ~6:57.

Maps 

What to drop if you're late

- First: Cascadilla / Cornell.
- Then: shorten Buttermilk to the lower falls view.
- Keep Taughannock. Do not add Letchworth — the video's 7-mile gorge will miss Maghrib.

Saved for another trip

- Letchworth (Upper / Middle / Lower Falls)
- Carpenter Falls, Treman, Fillmore Glen

Bring these. Airbnbs often skip a bodna, decent pans, and enough plates for a group.

1. **Bodna** — bathroom water jug. Hosts almost never have one.
2. **Indoor flip flops** — for the shower and kitchen floor.
3. **Small frying pan** — many listings have one dull pan or none that you want to cook in.
4. **Condiments** — sauce packets, salt, chili, oil or mayo packets, tea bags. Assume the kitchen is bare.
5. **Plates, forks, and spoons** — bring a small set. Airbnb cutlery is often short a few pieces or plastic-only.
6. **Cups** — two real cups if you drink tea or need wudu.
7. **Sharp knife, sponge, and a little dish soap** — host knives are usually dull, and soap runs out.
8. **Trash bags and a few zip bags** — leftovers and a quick kitchen reset on the way out.
9. **Paper towels or napkins**
10. **Prayer mat** — plus a spare if more than one person is praying.
11. **Chargers and a short power strip** — outlets are rarely next to the bed.
12. **Meds and the toiletries you actually use** — pain relief, prescriptions, toothbrush, soap.
13. **Trail shoes with grip, extra socks, and a light rain layer** — for the gorges.

Text this tab. Buffalo Maghrib Friday is about 6:57 PM. Leave Ithaca by 3:30.

Pocket schedule

THU after lunch (from Marathon ~1 PM)

- Watkins Glen Gorge Trail (~2.2 mi, muddy stairs). North entrance if Main is packed.
- SheQuaga Falls – park S Genesee St, NOT the bridge.
- Back to Marathon by ~5:40. Sleep there.

FRI

- 7:15 leave Marathon, car packed
- Taughannock overlook, then gorge to the base
- Ithaca Falls (short)
- Halal lunch: Adam Grill or Casablanca
- Buttermilk: gorge up, rim down
- Cornell slope only if you're ahead
- 3:30 PM on I-90 toward Buffalo. Asr at a rest area. Maghrib ~6:57 in Buffalo.

Left out: Letchworth, Carpenter, Treman, Fillmore Glen.

Copyable Google Maps queries

Watkins Glen:

Watkins Glen State Park Main Entrance, Franklin St, Watkins Glen, NY

Watkins Glen quiet end:

Watkins Glen State Park North Entrance, Watkins Glen, NY

SheQuaga parking:

S Genesee St & W Main St, Montour Falls, NY

Taughannock Overlook:

Taughannock Falls Overlook, Taughannock Park Rd, Trumansburg, NY

Taughannock lower lot:

Taughannock Falls State Park Lower Parking, NY-89, Trumansburg, NY

Ithaca Falls:

Ithaca Falls Natural Area, Lake St, Ithaca, NY

Adam Grill (halal):

Adam Grill, 114 W Green St, Ithaca, NY

Casablanca (halal):

Casablanca Pizzeria & Halal Grill, 111 E State St, Ithaca, NY

Buttermilk Falls:

Buttermilk Falls State Park Lower Entrance, Ithaca, NY

Cornell slope:

Libe Slope, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY

Tonight:

Marathon, NY

Friday night:

Buffalo, NY

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